

well, if not exactly kicking. That will also keep me out of Delhi where I am bombarded with bad advice from people who were ejected from power, telling me how to stay in power.

BUDDHADEB BHATTACHARYA

To decide once and for all whether to show my Marxist face or a capitalist one to avoid looking red-faced; to stop declaring "SEZ who?" when faced with opposition; to visit Nandigram more often and bond with the victims since they are mostly bonded labour; to actually read some books written by Taslima Nasreen so I can sound more intellectual than people believe I am, and, incidentally, also get to know why she is such a pain in the nether regions, and finally, start consulting Jyotibabu on how to repair a damaged ego and image, not to mention the party.

To stop sounding like the Grim Reaper, doomsday prophet and bashful bride all at the same time.

PRAKASH KARAT
GENERAL SECRETARY, CPI (M)



To avoid going to states that are due for elections so that newspapers will stop publishing numbers of Congress votes in the constituencies I visited.

RAHUL GANDHI
CONGRESS MP



MANMOHAN SINGH

To finally get tough and defy the Left, BJP and almost every other party opposing the nuclear deal on grounds that a Bush in hand is worth a few feathers flying; to sound and act more prime ministerial; to actually start walking ahead of Sonia Gandhi at official functions; to push the reform agenda more forcefully and remind everyone that I am the prime minister and I have her permission to say so. However, these resolutions were penned before I was reminded that this could be election year so to stop worrying about the bomb and start paying attention to *aam admi*. For a new, New Year resolution, watch this space.

PRAKASH KARAT

To stop sounding like the Grim Reaper, doomsday prophet and bashful bride all at the same time. To learn from Sonijai how to maintain one's balance while walking a tightrope and from the prime minister how to maintain integrity in the face of great temptation from the Great Satan who lives on Pennsylvania Avenue in Washington, and from Sitaram Yechury on how to sound optimistic and pessimistic at the same time while giving sound bites to television channels. Finally, to sort out the mess that the Left finds itself in, in the two states that it rules so that I can repeat the novel feeling of appearing on magazine covers for another year.

RAHUL GANDHI

To continue with the hair raising experiences of 2007 and take a vow to ask at last two more questions in the Parliament, which will make it a grand total of three. To find a good eye specialist so that he/she can do something about focussing my vision, to find out who compiled Indira Gandhi's 20-point programme and Sanjay uncle's five-point programme so that I can finally inform the country that, like my late father, I too have a dream and an agenda; and also to avoid going to states that are due for elections so that newspapers will stop publishing the number of votes the Congress gets in the constituencies I visit.

ATAL BIHARI VAJPAYEE

To...to...be...remembered.

SHAH RUKH KHAN

To advance to 12-pack abs so that the dispute about who is Number One is finally put to rest; to be offered a movie with Amitabh Bachchan so I can have the satisfaction of refusing; to star opposite Ash in a steamy romantic film so that the Bachchans get upset; to sign on for every foreign tour by film stars which features the Bachchans so that I can upstage them, to sign more films than Amitabh, win more awards than Amitabh; and to try and remove this perception that I am obsessed with Amitabh. ■